

Privacy Notice

How Jackson Hacks collects, uses, shares, safeguards, and deletes personal information.

Version 2026-10-03 | Last updated October 3, 2026

1. Scope and accountability

This Privacy Notice applies to the Jackson Hacks website, account system, applications, reviews, attendance administration, judging, and Event communications. Jackson Hacks is a student club operating through A. Y. Jackson Secondary School and subject to applicable school and TDSB privacy requirements.

Questions, access requests, correction requests, deletion requests, or privacy concerns may be sent to ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com.

2. Information collected

Depending on how a person uses the website, Jackson Hacks may collect account identifiers, name, email, phone number, age, country, city, province or state, school, grade, experience level, written application responses, dietary information, shirt size, emergency contact details, application status, review records, project information, waiver status, communications, and basic security or technical logs. City-level location helps with Event planning and understanding where applicants are travelling from; the application does not request a street address.

The application may also request optional demographic information, including gender identity, pronouns, and race or ethnicity.

If you choose to join the email updates list, we collect your email address, the Event cycle, signup time, signup source, and the wording and version of your email consent. Joining this list does not create an account, submit an application, or guarantee admission.

3. Purposes

Information is used to create and secure accounts; determine eligibility; receive, review, and administer applications; communicate decisions; plan capacity, meals, accessibility, and shirts; administer guardian permission and emergency processes; operate check-in; judge projects; distribute prizes; enforce safety and conduct rules; investigate incidents; secure the website; and improve future Events.

Email-list subscribers separately opt in to the application-opening announcement and Jackson Hacks 2027 updates. This consent is optional and is not required to apply or attend. You may withdraw it at any time by emailing ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com. We will stop these optional messages within 10 business days of an unsubscribe request. Email updates will identify Jackson Hacks and provide unsubscribe instructions.

4. Demographic survey

Age is required for eligibility. All other demographic questions are optional. Declining to answer an optional demographic question does not make an application incomplete.

Optional demographic information is not used to calculate application scores or make admission decisions and is not displayed to reviewers while they score applications. Authorized administrators may use it for aggregate inclusion, reach, and outreach reporting. Public reports will use grouped information and will not intentionally identify individuals.

5. Consent and participants under 18

Jackson Hacks presents collection purposes in language intended to be understandable to high-school students. A parent or guardian must complete required Event forms for a participant under 18. Optional information may be withheld unless it is later required for an accommodation, emergency process, or another clearly stated purpose.

6. Application reviewers and administrators

Authorized reviewers receive only the application information needed for scoring and do not receive optional demographic responses. Authorized administrators may access additional information when needed for eligibility, communications, inclusion reporting, safety, food, accommodations, incident response, or Event operations.

Reviewer scores, notes, deliberations, and identities are confidential internal records.

7. Service providers

Jackson Hacks uses service providers for functions such as hosting, authentication, database storage, email delivery, monitoring, and security. Providers may process information on Jackson Hacks' behalf and may operate systems outside Ontario or Canada, where information can be subject to local law.

Service providers receive only the information reasonably needed to perform their functions and are not authorized by Jackson Hacks to use application information for their own marketing.

8. Other disclosures

Personal information is not sold. It is not shared with sponsors, mentors, judges, or other organizations for their independent marketing without separate notice and any required consent.

Information may be disclosed when reasonably necessary to respond to an emergency, protect a person from a serious safety risk, investigate fraud or misconduct, secure systems, comply with law, or work with authorized school personnel.

9. Retention and deletion

Application answers, optional demographics, emergency contacts, reviewer scores, and unnecessary account information are scheduled for deletion or de-identification within 90 days after the Event. Information connected to a safety incident, security investigation, prize, legal obligation, or active dispute may be kept longer only as reasonably necessary.

Signed waivers and school-required forms follow the retention period approved by A. Y. Jackson Secondary School or TDSB and are not covered by the automatic 90-day deletion commitment until that period is confirmed. Aggregate statistics that no longer identify a person may be retained.

The email updates list is for Jackson Hacks 2027 only. Subscriber addresses are removed from the active list following an unsubscribe request or within 90 days after the Event. A minimal consent or unsubscribe record may be retained where reasonably required to demonstrate compliance or prevent further unwanted messages.

10. Security

Jackson Hacks uses access controls, private storage, authenticated accounts, database permissions, and other reasonable safeguards appropriate to the information. No internet service can guarantee absolute security. Suspected unauthorized access or disclosure should be reported immediately to ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com.

11. Website data

The website may use essential cookies or local storage to maintain authentication and security. Technical records may include timestamps, browser or device information, approximate network information, and error or security events. Non-essential analytics or advertising technologies will require an updated notice and any required choice or consent.

12. Access, correction, and deletion requests

Applicants can edit their application while submissions remain open. A person may also request access to, correction of, or deletion of their information by contacting ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com. Identity may need to be verified before a request is completed. Some information may be retained where required for safety, security, legal, or school-record obligations.

13. Photography and recordings

The Event will be photographed and recorded. Attendance requires the separate media release, including parent or guardian authorization for participants under 18. Media use, duration, and permitted purposes are described in that release.

14. Updates

This Notice may be updated when practices, services, school requirements, or law change. The current version date will be displayed, and material changes affecting submitted applications or confirmed participants will be communicated where reasonably practical.